UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND, JOHANNESBURG | WSoE Wits School of Education

WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Ushicilelo 4 · 12 uLwezi 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Kuleli sonto elilandelayo ngemva kwamasonto amabili, ingxoxo idlulele ekubuzeni ukuthi abafundi basebenzisa yini i-AI, iye ekubuzeni ukuthi bayisebenzisa kangakanani kahle: ucwaningo olusha oluvela e-Australia, eNingizimu Afrika nase-Nigeria luvumelana ukuthi umkhuba nokujula kokuzibandakanya, hhayi ukufinyelela noma amagama asenqubomgomo, yikho okubikezela ukufunda okuhle kanye nethuba elingcono lokuthuthuka komfundi. Izikhungo ziphendula ngokungafani: ezinye zibheka ohlolweni abhekene bodwa namanqubomgomo aqinile ngokukhohlisa, kanti ezinye, kuhlanganise neWits ngesikhungo sayo esisha, iGlobal Higher Education Futures Centre, zikhethe ukwakha indlela yokufundisa namandla ocwaningo esikhundleni sokubheka njengokunye. Izibalo zekota yesithathu ze-Statistics South Africa zisikhumbuza ukuthi kungani lokhu kubalulekile lapha: ukungasebenzi kwentsha kwehle kancane kuphela kuya ku-47.3%, ngakho isithelo sehora ngalinye lokufunda kusadingeka sizuzwe. Ku-Wits AHEAD, umsebenzi uhlala ufana: ukusiza abafundi abaphothule ukuphendula ikhono, hhayi ukufinyelela kuphela, kube ithuba.

IZINTO EZINTATHU OKUFANELE UZAZI

1

NEWS · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Office for Students tells universities to bring back in-person exams to protect assessment from AI

I-Office for Students yaseNgilandi itshele amanyuvesi ukuba acabangele ukubuyela ezivivinyweni ezibhalwa ngobuso nobuso, ezivalwe amabhuku, ku-viva kanye nemisebenzi yokusebenza ngqo, ukuze ukuhlolwa kuhlale kunobuqotho njengoba i-AI ekhiqizayo isabalala. Lesi siqondiso silandela ucwaningo lwezinyanga ezine olwenziwe ne-Advance HE, olususelwe ezingxoxweni nabafundi nabasebenzi abalinganiselwa ku-300 emanyuvesini angaphezu kwe-120, olwathola ukuthi ukusetshenziswa kwe-AI kusabalele kakhulu futhi ukuthi ukuhlolwa okunye akusahambisani nenjongo yakho. Kungokuqala umlawuli abeke ngqo imikhuba ye-AI yamanyuvesi engase ibangele ukungenelela, kuhlanganise nokunikezwa kweziqu ezisezingeni eliphansi.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Insika yokuqala kaWits AHEAD iyi-AI ekhiqizayo emfundweni ephakeme, kuhlanganise nokuhlolwa nobuqotho; ukuthi umlawuli kazwelonke eqa esuka eziqondisweni aye emiphumeleni enamandla ngomthetho kuphawula okunye amazwe, kuhlanganise iNingizimu Afrika, angase akuqaphele.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda emthonjeni

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). OfS pushes in-person exams to 'protect sector's reputation'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ofs-pushes-person-exams-protect-sectors-reputation

2

REPORT · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Graduates' wellbeing and civic contribution should be tracked alongside pay, British Academy argues

I-British Academy ithi izilinganiso zamanje zempumelelo yabathweswe iziqu zigxile kakhulu kuphela emholweni, futhi ifuna ukuthi ukulingana kwempilo nomsebenzi, impilo yomzimba yesikhathi eside, nokuzibandakanya kwezombangazwe nakho kulandelelwe. Ikhomba ucwaningo lohulumeni oluthole ukuthi amaphesenti angu-24 abathweswe iziqu bayavolontiya ngokuhleleka okungenani kanye ngenyanga, uqhathaniswa namaphesenti angu-17 kwabangenazo iziqu, futhi iphakamisa ukuhlanganiswa kwedatha yemfundo ephakeme nalolo lwezempilo nobugebengu ukuze kwakhiwe isithombe esigcwele.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Insika yesine kaWits AHEAD ihlanganisa ikhono lomuntu lwabathweswe iziqu kanye nokuqasheka kwabo ngale komsebenzi wokuqala; ukuphakanyiswa kwe-British Academy kwezilinganiso zomphumela ezibanzi kukhuluma ngqo nendlela iqembu elichaza ngayo 'impumelelo' ngabafundi balo.

British Academy, reported by Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda emthonjeni

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). Graduates' work-life balance 'should be tracked alongside pay'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/graduates-work-life-balance-should-be-tracked-alongside-pay

3

REPORT · 10 NOVEMBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Youth unemployment eases slightly to 47.3% as overall unemployment rises to 33.7% in the third quarter of 2026

Izinga elisemthethweni lokungasebenzi linyuke ngamaphuzu ayizinkomba angu-0.1 laya ku-33.7% ekotheni yesithathu ka-2026, njengoba ukuqashwa kukhulile ngabantu abangu-101,000 kwaba yizigidi ezingu-16.8, kodwa abasebenzi babakhulu ngesivinini esikhudlwana. Ukungasebenzi kwentsha (iminyaka 15 kuya ku-34) kwehle ngamaphuzu angu-0.1 kwaya ku-47.3%: intsha engasebenzi yehla ngo-23,000 yaya ezigidini ezingu-5.0, kanti intsha eqashiwe yehla ngo-5,000 yaya ezigidini ezingu-5.5.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Leli yinani iqembu elilisebenzisayo kwizindlela zabathweswe iziqu nezinguquko ezinobulungiswa. Isigxobo 4 sibuza ukuthi i-AI inciphisa noma yandisa lesi sikhala kuleli qembu ngqo.

Statistics South Africa · statssa.gov.za · Funda emthonjeni

Statistics South Africa. (2026, November 10). *Quarterly Labour Force Survey (QLFS): Q3 2026* [Press release]. statssa.gov.za/publications/P0211/Media%20Release%20QLFS%20Q3%202026.pdf

UCWANINGO NEMIBIKO

Wits opens a Global Higher Education Futures Centre, with a dedicated generative AI pedagogy hub

University of the Witwatersrand · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Ngesinsika 6, leli yunivesithi laseNingizimu Afrika liyakha uhlaka lwalo oluqondile lokucabanga mayelana nokuphazanyiswa kwemfundo ephakeme yi-AI, kunokuba lithathe elakhelwe kwenye indawo, okuyindlela kanye okuholwa ngayo amazwe aseNingizimu Yomhlaba, egxile ekulinganeni, eyimigomo kanye nenjongo u-Wits AHEAD osekelwe ngayo.

University of the Witwatersrand. (2026, November 9). Wits launches the Global Higher Education Futures Centre. wits.ac.za/news/latest-news/research-news/2026/2026-11/wits-launches-the-global-higher-education-futures-centre.html

AI-generated 'slop' papers published under prominent academics' names without their consent

Times Higher Education · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Ngesinsika 6, lesi senzakalo sikhombisa indlela i-AI ekhiqizayo engasetshenziswa ngayo ukwenza amanga, hhayi kuphela imiphumela yocwaningo, kodwa nobunikazi babacwaningi uqobo, okuyinto okudinga ukuthi inqubomgomo ye-AI enokuzibophezela kwimfundo ephakeme inwetshwe ukufaka ubuqotho bokushicilela, ingagcini ekilasini.

Asaf, S. (2026, November 9). 'AI slop' papers published under prominent academics' names. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ai-slop-papers-published-under-prominent-academics-names

Wording of university generative AI policies shapes how students and teachers actually behave, study finds

arXiv preprint (University of Maryland and University of Iowa researchers) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Ngesinsika 1, lolu cwaningo lukhombisa ukuthi inqubomgomo ye-AI ekhiqizayo ilungile kuphela uma indlela ebhalwe ngayo ilungile: amanyuvesi abhala noma abuyekeza imithetho yawo ye-AI ekufundiseni nasekuhloleni kudingeka ahlole hhayi kuphela ukuthi umthetho uvumela yini, kodwa nendlela abafundi nabasebenzi abazoyifunda bazenze ngayo amagama ngawo uqobo.

Mehreen, S., Yuan, X., Nithyanand, R., & Hoque, N. (2026). *Wording matters: Understanding how GenAI policy rules shape teachers' and students' workflows and perceptions*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11072

How deeply students engage with an AI chat, not how often they use it, predicts better coursework, large Australian study finds

University of Queensland and Monash University (arXiv preprint, submitted to the Journal of Computer Assisted Learning) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 2: Analytics for student success. Ngesinsika 2, lokhu kubaluleke kunoma yisiphi isikhungo esakha ukuhlaziywa kwedatha ngokusetshenziswa kwamathuluzi e-AI: ukubala kaningi abafundi abavula i-chatbot akutsheli lutho oluningi ngokufunda, ngakho izinhlelo ezihloswe ukusekela impumelelo yabafundi kudingeka zibheke ubujulile bokuzibandakanya, hhayi inani lokuchofoza.

Zhuang, X., Bakharia, A., Gašević, D., & Khosravi, H. (2026). *From dialogue to task: How cognitive engagement with generative artificial intelligence relates to post-dialogue activity and task outcomes*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11435

BUKELA

▶ World Bank video: 'small AI', not big models alone, can widen opportunity in developing-economy education and jobs (1 hr 16 min)

World Bank Group (YouTube). Kumhlangano womhlaba wonke we-AI kanye nokwedijithali eSeoul, obuqoshwe yiWorld Bank Group, uMongameli wayo u-Ajay Banga wavula ingxoxo mayelana nendlela amathuluzi "e-AI encane" asebenzayo futhi avumelaniswe nezimo zendawo, hhayi kuphela amamodeli amakhulu avamile, angakwazi ukwandisa amathuba emnothweni osathuthuka. UNgqongqoshe wezokuXhumana, Ukusungula Kabusha Nomnotho Wedijithali waseNigeria, u-Bosun Tijani, wajoyina isikhulu esiphezulu se-Tridge u-Hoshik Shin kanye nomsunguli we-Amini u-Kate Kallot ukuxoxa ngemfundo, ezolimo kanye nezinsiza zomphakathi, kufaka phakathi ingxenye ekhuluma ngezifundo ezitholakele ekusetshenzisweni kwe-AI emfundweni eEl Salvador. Iqembu leli liphawule idatha yendawo ethembekile, ukuxhumana okuyinganekwane, amandla okubala, amakhono kanye nezinqubo zokuthenga njengezimo ezivumela abasunguli bendawo ukuthi bakhulise izixazululo zabo ze-AI.

OKUVELA EQENJINI

12 uMandulo 2026 **Ubudlelwano: i-Australia ijoyina imephu ye-Footprint, ukubambisana neNyuvesi yaseMurdoch, ePerth, kuseqhutshekwa**
Ukuhlola umsebenzi ohlangene nge-AI nemfundo phakathi kweWits neMurdoch; isivumelwano sokuqonda siyalungiswa.

12 uMandulo 2026 **Umbiko wocwaningo weMasters uqedwe ngodumo; umuntu uzothola iziqu ngoDisemba 2026**
Ukubuyekezwa kwemibhalo ngobunkisimethiriki yobuholi obususelwa kudatha nokwakhwa kwenqubomgomo; umuntu manje uthuthela kusiphakamiso se-doctoral.

12 uMandulo 2026 **Ithesisi ye-doctoral iqedwe; umuntu uzothola iziqu ngoDisemba 2026**
Ukulungiswa okudingwa ngababhali bemibuzo kwamukelwe ocwaningweni mayelana nabafundi bemfundo yebanga elide ababe nempumelelo enkulu emfundweni ephakeme yaseMpumalanga Afrika.

OKUFUNDWAYO ESIKUPHAKAMISAYO

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Yilo u-H oku-AHEAD. Qala lapha.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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